

things greatly for Android developers. If a wide range of compelling apps that look good on your tablet is your main priority, Apple is currently the best at it.

Screen size and storage

This is probably obvious, but size, both screen real estate and storage capacity is important for many of us. Firstly when someone says 10 inch tablet, this normally refers only to the size of the screen, measured diagonally, and not the actual size of the tablet itself. Apple continues to offer the new iPad and the iPad 2 with a 9.7 inch screen and the BlackBerry PlayBook comes in a single 7 inch variety, which RIM argues gives it the advantage of being able to pocket it. Samsung, for one, wants you to have a choice, so it offers its Android tablets in multiple screen sizes 10.1, 8.9, 7 inches, and even a phone cum tablet hybrid the Samsung Note with a 5-inch display and a stylus.

Screen resolution is important too, especially for ebook reading and Web surfing. A sharp, bright display is extremely important. Right now, the new iPad has a 2048x1536 pixel Retina display and this is the sharpest and best you will find out there. If you're in the market for a 10-inch Android tablet, look for a display with at least 1280x800 resolution. For 7-inch models: The Amazon Kindle Fire comes with 1024 x 600, and is perfectly viewable, even for ebook reading.

Choosing a Tablet: Over a laptop or a smartphone

The weight and portability of a tablet is its biggest advantage over a laptop, but to be very correct, it's definitely not as light as a mobile phone, this stands true even in the case of 7 inch tablets as well. After you hold one on a bus for ten minutes, your hand will get tired. Setting it flat in your lap, rather than propped up on a stand, can also be a little awkward. Again, a 10 inch tablet doesn't fit into pockets most of the time.

As for storage, the more the better, all those apps, when combined with a typical music, video, and photo library, can take up a lot of space. Right now storage maximum is at 64GB of flash based memory, with most of the tablets available in 16, 32, and 64GB varieties. Larger capacity models can get about as expensive as full-featured laptops, though, especially when you factor in cellular service plans. Many tablets come in a Wi-Fi-only model or with the option of always-on cellular service from a wireless provider. Finally, before you buy, make sure you head to your local electronics store to get some hands on time with some different tablets, so you can see which feels and works the best for you. 